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# Around the Island: See Alameda officials' positions in Legislative Agenda

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In Alameda, your elected mayor and city councilmembers adopt policies and programs that best serve Alamedans. Sometimes, however, state or federal policies determine what the city can do.

In those cases, the city can advocate for itself and our residents and businesses. That process starts with the City Council's adopted Legislative Agenda, which details the city's priorities and supports measures that promote social equity, enhance the quality of life of Alameda residents and address ongoing COVID-19 response and recovery efforts. With the city's priorities in mind, we review hundreds of bills each year to determine which align with Alameda's interests. We then consider sharing our support (or opposition) as these bills make their way through the legislative process.

For example, to help curb the theft of catalytic converters, the city supports legislation that restricts their sales. This year, two of the bills that the city supported passed the state Legislature and are on the governor's desk awaiting action. AB 1740, authored by Assemblymember Al Muratsuchi, D-Torrance, requires a core recycler (a business that buys used auto parts) that buys a used catalytic converter to acquire a written record from the seller of the year, make, model and vehicle identification number (VIN) of the vehicle it came from along with a copy of its title. SB 1087, authored by state Sen. Lena Gonzalez, D-Long Beach, prohibits a person or core recycler from buying a used catalytic converter except from specific sellers.

The city supports measures that make Alameda safer for pedestrians and bicyclists and increase enforcement of speed violations. AB 1909, authored by Assemblymember Laura Friedman, D-Burbank, changes the rules and restrictions on bicycle operations to increase bicyclist safety. AB 2000, authored by Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel, D-Woodland Hills, prohibits the exhibition of motor vehicle speed in a parking lot if the violation occurs as part of a sideshow. Both measures were passed by the Legislature and are on the governor's desk awaiting action.

The city supports gun safety, common-sense gun laws and policies that keep guns out of the wrong hands. AB 2156, authored by Assemblymember Buffy Wicks, D-Oakland, will expand prohibitions on the manufacture of firearms without a state license. AB 2239, authored by Assemblymember Brian Maienschein, D-San Diego, creates a 10-year firearm prohibition for individuals convicted of child or elder abuse involving violence. Both bills have been signed into law.

The city supports policing and racial equity consistent with actions taken by the City Council and legislation that addresses systemic racism and promotes social equity.

AB 2147, authored by Assemblymember Phil Ting, D-San Francisco, prohibits a peace officer from stopping a pedestrian for illegally crossing the street (jaywalking) unless there is an immediate danger. AB 2773, authored by Assemblymember Chris Holden, D-Pasadena, would require a peace officer making a traffic stop to state the reason for the stop before asking further questions unless the officer reasonably believes that withholding information is necessary. Both bills were passed by the Legislature and are on the governor's desk awaiting action.

Sometimes the city works with lawmakers to sponsor a bill, such as AB 2319, authored by Assemblymember Mia Bonta, D-Oakland. The Surplus Land Act is existing state law intended to make public lands available for affordable housing before being sold to private parties.

This bill changes the definition of "exempt surplus land" to include the former Alameda Naval Air Station, meaning that Alameda Point properties will be exempt from the Surplus Land Act process if the city satisfies certain affordable housing requirements. The city can therefore proceed to sell or lease the land consistent with previously

approved plans, bringing new housing units and economic development to the city of Alameda. This bill passed the Legislature and is on the governor's desk awaiting action.

And sometimes the city supports legislation that requires voter approval — for example, SCA 10, authored by state Sen. Toni Atkins, D-San Diego, which amends the California Constitution to prohibit the state from denying or interfering with a woman's reproductive freedom, including her fundamental right to an abortion. This measure passed the Legislature and has been placed on this November's ballot.

Finally, the Legislature is responsible for passing a balanced budget that reflects California's values. This year, the governor signed the Budget Act of 2022, allocating $1.8 million of state funds to Alameda's Fire Department led-CARE Team (Community Assessment Response & Engagement), a 24/7/365 alternative response to police for individuals facing mental health crises. Many thanks go to Assemblymember Mia Bonta for championing funding for this critical project as part of the budget process.

To review a current list of bills that the city supports, visit alamedaca.gov/legislativeaffairs.

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